Notes from the Map Room

Archive practice

The map room occupies the quiet end of the neighborhood library. Its shelves hold folded street plans, ferry schedules, and hand-drawn routes collected over several decades. A small brass weight keeps each sheet flat while readers compare editions.

Reading old maps

Mara volunteers on Thursday afternoons. She records the paper's date, the names of its surveyors, and any handwritten notes near the margins. When a street changes, she adds a transparent overlay rather than altering the older map.

Archive item	Recorded detail
Street plan	Survey date
Overlay	Transparent sheet
Map weight	Brass